

Cardano Beginner Onboarding Playbook

Production Consensus Guide for Authors & Regional Coordinators

Purpose

This consensus guide consolidates the feedback and agreements reached in our planning discussions. It exists to direct the creation of an onboarding Playbook that helps beginners around the world enter — and, just as importantly, *stay in* — the Cardano ecosystem.

A core requirement agreed by all participants: the Playbook must clearly distinguish between two audiences.

- **End-users** — people who simply want to use Cardano (wallets, staking, apps) and need no complex development skills.
- **Builders** — people who want to develop on Cardano and need technical depth.

The bulk of onboarding effort, and the priority ordering below, is aimed at **end-users**. Builder content is secondary and should be clearly separated so beginners are never overwhelmed by it.

1. Core Curriculum & Top Priorities

The Playbook should be built around six foundational topics:

1. **Blockchain fundamentals 30%:** introduced in general terms, then using Cardano as the working example.
2. **Wallet operation & transactions 25%**
3. **Security & self-custody 25%**
4. **The ecosystem & Dapps 10%**
5. **Staking & delegation 5%**
6. **Governance 5%**

Weighting for each topic %

Agreed priority ordering. Participants strongly recommended that **Wallets, Staking, and Security** come *first*, because these connect most directly to a newcomer's immediate interests and everyday use. **Governance and DApps/applications can be introduced later**, once the basics are comfortable.

2. Value Proposition & Chain Abstraction

Keep the focus on what users actually care about.

- **Main course, not side dishes.** Do not over-emphasize underlying technology such as Plutus or Haskell (the “side dishes”). Concentrate on the “main course” users value in practice: real functionality, low fees, fast transaction speed, and staking yield.
- **Plain language and analogies.** Teach promoters to speak in everyday terms for example, framing the Cardano experience as “better than your bank,” describing ADA as “digital land,” and showcasing concrete “Web3 utility.” Deliberately avoid dense crypto jargon.
- **Minimum necessary knowledge + chain abstraction.** For Web2 users, provide only the minimum knowledge required to get started. Use chain abstraction so users can experience Web3 seamlessly without noticing the underlying complexity. Avoid teaching deep mechanics such as Ouroboros at the beginner stage.

3. Security & Low-Risk Onboarding

Crypto carries a strong public stigma around **scams and “rug pulls.”** The Playbook should directly address this fear and emphasize the safety of early participation.

- **Start low-risk.** Do not push newcomers into trading random, high-volatility tokens on day one. Guide them toward low-risk activities first, above all staking and delegation.
- **Local scam awareness.** Include prevention training built around scam patterns and cases common in each specific region.
- **Wallet security practices.** Cover the security practices that differ across wallets, so users learn safe self-custody from the start.

4. Retention & Follow-Up Design

To prevent drop-off after a single workshop, the Playbook should include concrete retention mechanics.

- **Concrete task + incentive.** Set the workshop’s completion criterion as “complete your first staking delegation by the end of the session.” Follow up roughly one week later, offering a small amount of ADA or an NFT as an incentive to return.
- **Community ritual.** Teach organizers how to build a recurring community “ritual” for example, regular gatherings to celebrate the end of an Epoch so participation becomes habitual rather than one-off.
- **Proactive notifications.** Use in-app push systems (such as the Vesper wallet banner, or a Catalyst-style app) to actively notify users about ecosystem news and governance votes they care about.

5. Local Self-Learning Resources

The Playbook should integrate regional creators' online resources so beginners can keep learning on their own after a session.

- **Taiwan / Chinese-speaking community (example).** This community relies heavily on YouTube channels such as 區塊鏈日報 (Derek), Bullish Dumpling (餌子), and 大懶貓 (Eric).
- **Explorer tools.** Include introductions to widely used blockchain explorers such as Cexplorer and Cardanoscan.
- **Localize per region.** Each regional coordinator should add their own equivalent creators, channels, and trusted resources for their language and market.

Guiding Principles (Summary)

- Separate **end-users** from **builders**; lead with end-users.
- Lead with **Wallets, Staking, Security**; defer Governance and DApps.
- Sell **utility and benefits**, not technology.
- Keep beginners **low-risk and safe**.
- Design for **retention**, not one-off attendance.
- **Localize** resources for each region.